PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Mercedes-Benz G-Class (second generation)

2018–present · “W463A” · G 550 · G 580

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- ☐ **Check recall 23V097**
  26,116 US 2019–2021 G 550s and AMG G 63s were recalled because the front-axle wiring harness can chafe on the oil cooler, killing ABS and stability control. Confirm by VIN that the inspection and sleeve or harness were done.
- ☐ **Test lockers and low range**
  Select low range and each lock on a loose surface. The ‘G’ icon should appear and every locker indicator should confirm. Most of these trucks have never been asked.
- ☐ **Look under the middle**
  Owner reports point to transfer-case output-seal leaks on 2013–2023 trucks: oil spots under the centre, wet housing, whine. Check the driveshaft flanges for wear marks too.
- ☐ **Open every door**
  The doors are heavy; owners report hinge sag. Check that each door closes cleanly with that famous bank-vault clack and lines up with its neighbors.
- ☐ **Drive it through a full shift cycle**
  Harsh or jerky 9-speed shifts are often an adaptation issue fixable with a dealer tool — but get it documented before purchase.
- ☐ **Exercise the screens and cameras**
  Infotainment freezes, reboots and blank camera feeds are reported; make sure software is current and the 360° camera works — you’ll want it on the trail.
- ☐ **Check the wheels and badges**
  Many trucks wear 21- or 22-inch wheels and AMG bodywork. Factory G 550 sizes are 275/55R19 or 275/50R20; budget for an 18- or 20-inch all-terrain setup, and check the VIN before paying a G 63 premium.
- ☐ **Rear door latches**
  Open and close both rear doors from inside and outside, and make sure each one latches fully. Then confirm that latch recalls 21V-353 and, for trucks that got a replacement latch, 24V-659 have been completed.

YEARS TO KNOW

2019–2021	RECALL	Early trucks carry several recalls, including the front-axle harness (23V097), diff-lock module (20V090) and rear door latch (21V353). Confirm by VIN that they were done

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Front-axle wiring harness chafe**
  2019–2021 · NHTSA 23V097
- [ ] **Differential-lock module resistor**
  2019–2020 · NHTSA 20V090
- [ ] **Rear door latch**
  2019–2021 · NHTSA 21V353
- [ ] **Replacement rear door latch**
  2019–2023 · NHTSA 24V659
- [ ] **Front door wiring harness routing**
  2019 · NHTSA 19V820
- [ ] **Fuel tank weld**
  2019 · NHTSA 21V564
- [ ] **Turbo oil feed line (AMG G 63)**
  2019 · NHTSA 20V048
- [ ] **Fuel pump shutdown**
  2021–2023 · NHTSA 23V445
- [ ] **ESP warning light (G 550, G 580, G 63)**
  2025 · NHTSA 25V254
- [ ] **Wheel bolts (G 580)**
  2025 · NHTSA 26V198

- [ ] **VIN characters 4–8**
  Bring a Trailer examples decoded with NHTSA's vPIC tool: 2019 G 550 = WDCYC6BJ..., 2019 AMG G 63 = WDCYC7HJ..., 2023 G 550 = W1NYC6BJ..., 2025 G 550 (inline-six) = W1NWH1AB..., 2025 G 580 = W1NWM0AB.... A 'G 63' with a YC6 VIN is a G 550 in AMG clothing.
- [ ] **WDC versus W1N**
  The 2019 examples start WDC and the 2023–2025 examples start W1N. Both are Mercedes-Benz manufacturer prefixes, and vPIC decodes both as Graz-built G-Class.
- [ ] **Model year (10th character)**
  K = 2019, L = 2020, P = 2023, S = 2025. The V8 G 550 runs through 2024; 2025-on G 550s are inline-six mild hybrids.
- [ ] **'W463A' isn't official**
  'W463A' is an enthusiast and media label. Mercedes kept the W463 chassis code for the 2018-on truck, and the 2024 update has been reported as W465.
- [ ] **Electric G 580**
  The G 580 has no mechanical lockers. It uses per-wheel torque vectoring with a 2:1 low range in each axle's transmission.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/g-class/second-gen/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks